

identification, but it seems certain that no site previously fixed upon comes so near to the fulfilment of all requisites of the case.

'Difficult as it seems to be to fix the site of the later cities of Jewish, Roman, and Byzantine times, there is happily but little doubt as to the position of the Jericho destroyed by Joshua. The "Sultan's Spring," or Fountain of Elisha, is indeed the only natural site for a city in the whole country surrounding it. Three fine springs are found within but a little distance of one another, while the rest of the plain can show but one, and that far less considerable. Nothing, indeed, but the curse on the site and the terror inspired by the subsequent fulfilment of that curse could account for the displacement of the city. The flight of the spies to the hills points to the same position. From modern Jericho flight in any direction would be equally dangerous, but from 'Ain es Sultân a deep ravine covered with bushes of the Zakkûm and Spina Christi, and filled with a jungle of cane, leads to 'Ain Dûk (the ancient Doch or Dagon), at the foot of the cliff of Kûrîntûl, amongst whose caves and rocky precipices the two Israelites, flying to "the mountains," might lie hid in safety.

'The ruin at the spring itself seems to be that of a small Roman temple, such as is often found at springheads. Other foundations farther north contain capitals and shafts seemingly Byzantine. In the direction of er Riha, foundations, low mounds, channels for water, and portions of roads hidden in the thorny copse which here covers the plain, seem all to point to the former existence of a great town.

'Still farther south, near Wâdy Kelt, two large mounds or Tells command the road as it descends the narrow pass from Beit Jûbr. These have been considered as remains of Roman Jericho; pieces of wall, and perhaps of an aqueduct, with the *opus reticulatum* of its masonry, seem to confirm this theory. Close by is the fine reservoir, fed by aqueducts, known as the Birket Mûsa, measuring about 190 × 160 yards.

'There is a very large number of Tells in the neighbourhood, all of the most important having been examined and excavated by Captain Warren. Of these, Tell el 'Ain el Samarât, Abu Zelef, Abu el Hindi, and el Arâis, with the Tullul Abu el Alayj are true Tells, artificial mounds with a central building of unburnt brick. Tell Deir Ghan'am, el Jurn, el Mutlub, Derb el Habaysh, el Kus, el Mefuriyeh and Moghyfir, with others still less important, are but heaps of *dëbris* formed by ruins of various date.

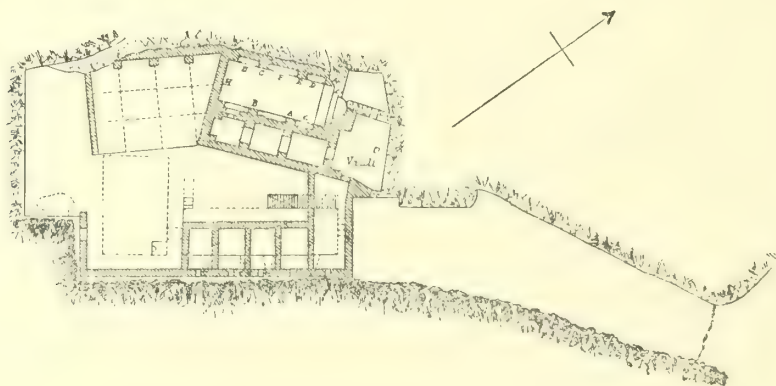
'Of our visits to the Hajar el Esbah, to Gumran, and 'Ain Feshkhah, I have nothing myself to relate. Nothing is more striking, however, than the general aspect of the country we have thus passed over. The broad plain, bounded east and west by the steep rocky ranges, at whose feet lie the low marl hillocks of a former geological sea; the green lawns of grass leading to the lower valley, where in the midst of a track of thick white mud the Jordan flows in a crooked milky stream, through jungles of cane and tamarisk—are all equally unlike the general scenery of Palestine. Round Elijah's fountain a tangled wood of Zakkûm, Spina Christi, and near the water an occasional castor-oil plant, spreads out to Jericho. The yellow berries of the deadly solanum appear everywhere. The chorus of birds and the flow of water are sounds equally unusual and charming in the stony wildernesses of the Holy Land.

'The palm groves of Jericho have disappeared since the eighth century. A solitary survivor grows close to the tower of er Riha, and in the valley north of Kûsr el Hajlah I met with another clump. When the copses of the fountain are left behind, and the first descent is made into the flat mud valley below the half-consolidated marl cliffs at Kûsr el Hajlah, then we are at once reminded of Josephus's expression, that the Jordan flowed "through a wilderness." The views of the lake—with its shining, oily surface, its salt and sulphurous

Birket Mûsa (O s).—A large pool fed by an aqueduct (see Wâdy Kelt) measuring 660 by 490 feet. The walls are only about 5 to 6 feet high, but the reservoir is probably much filled up. The masonry is small, but the walls are nearly 10 feet thick. The pool appears to have belonged to the system of aqueducts which lead to it, and to be of the same date.

Dabbûs el 'Abd (O s).—A column-shaft beside the road, apparently a Roman milestone.

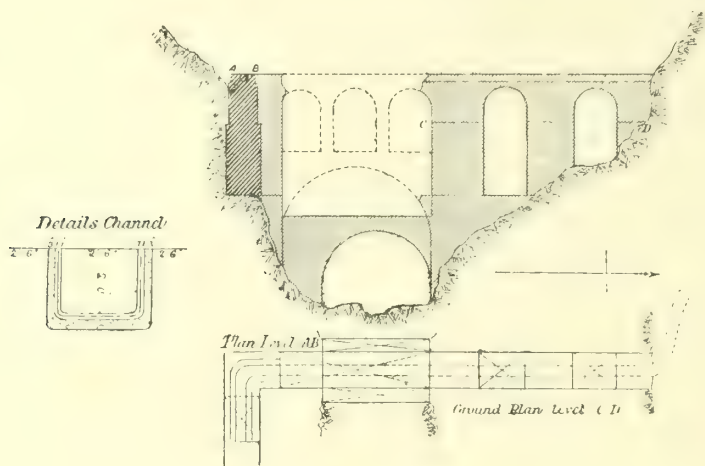
Deir el Kelt (O s).—A ruined monastery perched in the side of a perpendicular precipice on the north bank of Wâdy Kelt. (See Plan.) It is approached from the east, on which side is a narrow plateau (120 feet east and west, 30 feet broad) having above it a cliff. For over 80 feet in



length this cliff is covered with cement, which was once painted in fresco, with figures now obliterated. In the cliff above the monastery are caves, now inaccessible. In one an iron bar was visible, probably once used for fixing a rope or rope-ladder, by which a communication with the hermit in the cell might be effected.

The monastery itself shows three distinct dates of building. The edifice includes an entrance-hall with vaults below, a chapel and cells. The chapel is not in the same axis with the rest of the buildings, and appears to be earlier. The masonry in it is better dressed than in the rest of the work. The chapel is 36 feet long by 17 feet broad, interior measure. Its bearing is 45° . At the east end is an apse 7 feet diameter; this has a window in the side placed askew, so as to have a bearing 90° , or due east. Behind

opposite Deir el Kelt is a fine wall of masonry, similar to that of Jisr ed Deir, about 30 feet high, built against the cliff. The channel of the upper aqueduct runs on the top, and beneath there is a culvert through which the lower aqueduct runs, near the bottom of the wall. There is another small channel, about $\frac{1}{2}$ mile long, which joins the upper



aqueduct at Jisr ed Deir, coming from the south side of Wâdy Kelt. The upper channel runs occasionally uphill, though never, of course, as high as its original level at the 'Ain Kelt; on the top of the wall it is roofed in with flat stones, like the channel of the aqueduct at Cæsarea. The dimensions of the channel are given on the bridge.

As far as can be judged, these aqueducts are of the same date with the bridge, which is probably older than the Crusading epoch. They are probably to be ascribed to Roman times, or perhaps the Byzantine period; but are evidently older than the system described under the head Kanat Mûsa.

The two aqueducts from 'Ain Fârah run at a higher level, beside the road, south of Wâdy Kelt. Their course is extremely devious at one point; the channels cross and recross one another. In places they are tunneled through the hill. The high-level is carried across a ravine in one place, on a massive bridge of rubble-work, faced with ashlar, 120 feet long, 35 feet high, with a pointed arch. Near this is a cistern, resembling Beit Jûbr el Fôkâni, in masonry. At this point the

low-level channel crosses by a detour, without a bridge. Both aqueducts disappear at Beit Jübr el Fôkânî, and seem to run in tunnels to the neighbourhood of Beit Jübr et Tahtânî. Here the higher channel descends by a steep shoot, as previously described. The course of the low-level is not easily traceable, but it appears to have supplied the Birket Mûsa.

The high-level near Beit Jübr et Tahtânî has a cemented channel, with a semicircular arch to the roof. The low-level has also a cemented channel. The wall supporting the high-level (of rough masonry) is visible on the Jerusalem road, nearly opposite Deir el Kelt; and here there are remains of pipes of red earthenware.

There is nothing to fix the date of this pair of aqueducts beyond the pointed arch of the bridge. This may, perhaps, be a reconstruction. The buildings in connection with the channels are all comparatively late, as far as it is possible to determine their date.